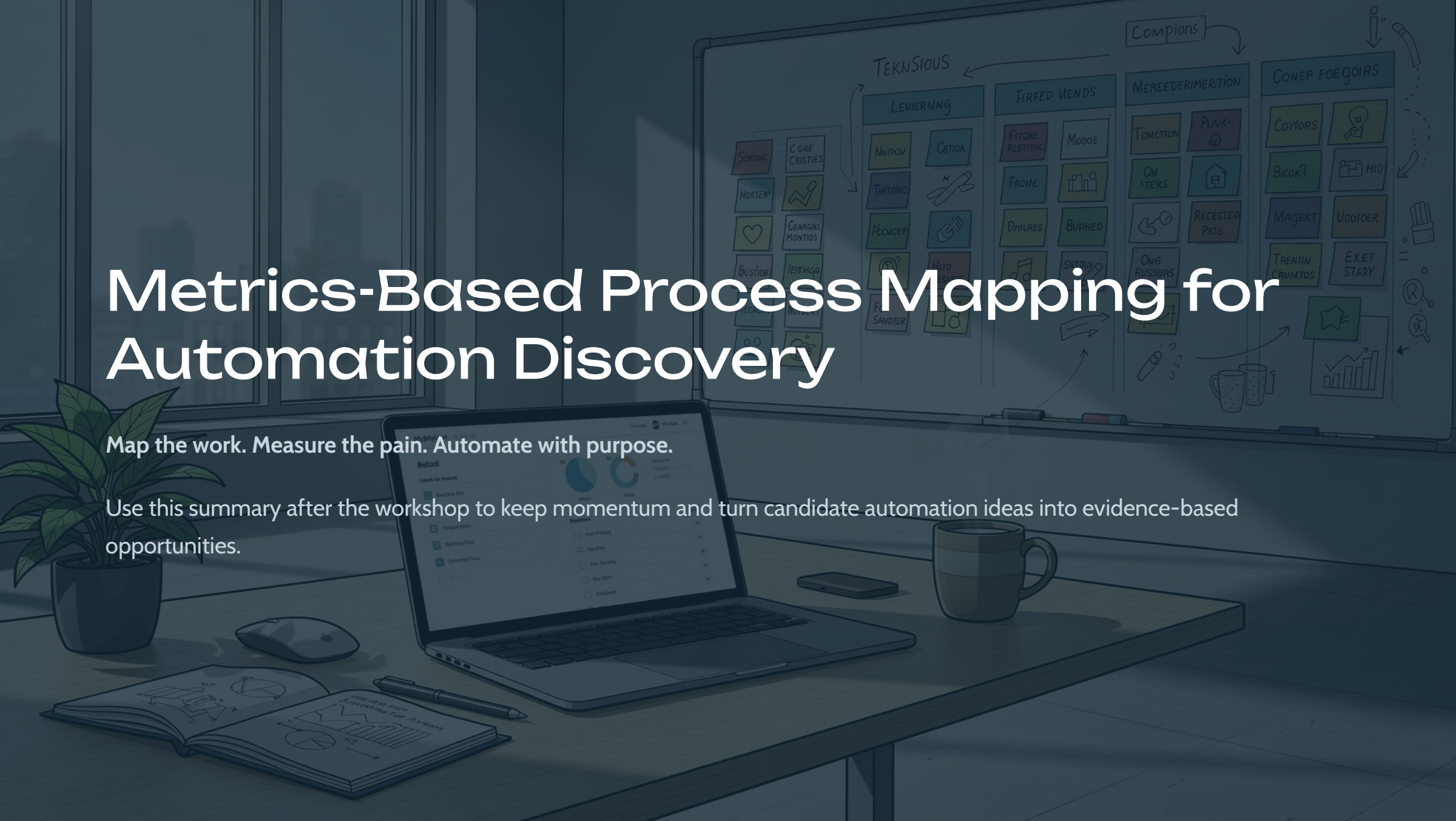


Metrics-Based Process Mapping for Automation Discovery

Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.

Use this summary after the workshop to keep momentum and turn candidate automation ideas into evidence-based opportunities.



What We Covered

The workshop introduced a simple, repeatable approach to identifying the right automation opportunities — not just the technically possible ones.

1

Map the Work

Understand how the process happens today

2

Measure the Pain

Add evidence about effort, delay, rework, risk or impact

3

Decide the Response

Determine whether automation, improvement, standardisation or investigation is needed

4

Prioritise the Opportunity

Focus on candidates that are valuable, feasible and ready

 The goal is not to automate everything. The goal is to identify the **right opportunities** and agree on the next best action.

What to Do Next

For each candidate process, work through these eight steps to build an evidence-based case before committing to automation.

1	Validate the Process Confirm the process with people who actually do the work.
2	Confirm Scope Agree on the start point, end point and desired outcome.
3	Capture the Steps Document main steps, systems, decisions, handoffs and exceptions.
4	Gather Metrics Collect or estimate useful measures of effort, flow and quality.
5	Identify the Pain Determine whether the pain is effort, flow, quality, risk or user impact.
6	Assess the Opportunity Evaluate value, feasibility and readiness using the three lenses.
7	Decide the Response Choose to automate, improve first, investigate further or defer.
8	Add to Backlog Track the opportunity if it is worth pursuing further.

Metrics to Gather

You do not need every metric. Choose the measures that best explain the pain and value of each candidate process.

Effort

- How often does this happen?
- How much human effort is involved?
- Where is repetitive or low-value work happening?

Flow

- How long does the process take end to end?
- Where does work wait?
- Where are the handoffs and which systems are touched?

Quality & Risk

- How often does work need correcting?
- How often are there exceptions?
- What happens if something goes wrong?

The Time Distinction

A slow process is not always an effort-heavy process. Understanding the type of time involved changes the response.

Cycle Time

Total elapsed time from start to finish

Touch Time

Actual human effort invested in the process

Wait Time

Time sitting idle between steps

Decide the Likely Response

Automation is one possible response, but not the only one. Match the pain point to the most appropriate action before committing resources.

Pain Point	Possible Response
Missing information	Better form, validation or guidance
Manual data entry	Integration or data transfer automation
Long approval delay	Workflow routing, reminders or escalation
Repeated status chasing	Automated notifications or dashboard
Frequent rework	Standardisation, validation or clearer rules
Inconsistent decisions	Decision tree, policy clarification or guardrails
Too many exceptions	Process redesign before automation
Poor visibility	Tracking, reporting or workflow transparency

- ❏ Not every pain point calls for automation. Choosing the right response first saves significant time and cost downstream.

Assess the Opportunity

Use three lenses to evaluate whether a candidate process is genuinely ready for automation investment.



Value

Is this worth solving? Does the benefit justify the effort and cost of automating?



Feasibility

Can we automate it? Are the systems, data and rules stable enough to support automation?



Readiness

Is the process ready? Is it documented, consistent and stable enough to automate now?

A good automation candidate is not just technically possible. It should be **valuable, feasible and ready**.

Opportunity Categories

Once assessed, place each candidate into one of four categories. This determines the next action and helps prioritise the backlog.

Automate Now

High value, feasible and ready. Move directly into automation discovery or design. These are your priority candidates.

Improve First

Worth solving, but the process needs tidying. Clarify, simplify, standardise or assign ownership before automating.

Investigate Further

Potential value, but more evidence is needed. Gather data or assess technical feasibility before committing.

Do Not Automate Yet

Low value, unstable or unclear. Defer or address underlying process issues first.

✔ Not ready for automation does not mean not worth improving. Every category has a productive next action.

7-Day Follow-Up Actions

In the first week after the workshop, focus on selecting candidates and beginning validation. Keep the momentum going while the workshop is fresh.

- 1 Select 2–3 candidate processes to take forward
- 2 Confirm who owns each candidate process
- 3 Validate the current-state process with people who do the work
- 4 Capture the normal path, key decisions, handoffs and exceptions
- 5 Identify which metrics matter most for each candidate
- 6 Separate known evidence from assumptions
- 7 Add each candidate to the opportunity backlog
- 8 Assign owners for missing evidence or validation actions

30-Day Follow-Up Actions

By the end of the first month, you should have a clear, evidence-based picture of your automation pipeline and a prioritised backlog ready for action.

Evidence & Assessment

- Gather missing metrics or evidence
- Complete the automation opportunity assessment for priority candidates
- Categorise each opportunity using the four categories
- Identify opportunities that need technical feasibility assessment

Backlog & Next Steps

- Identify quick wins that can move forward immediately
- Identify process improvements needed before automation
- Review and update the opportunity backlog
- Decide whether a follow-up session is needed

Templates to Use

These templates support each stage of the process. Use them to structure conversations, capture evidence and track progress.

Template	Use it to...
process-mapping-canvas.md	Validate how the process works today
metrics-checklist.md	Identify useful metrics and missing evidence
scenario-clinic-capture.md	Capture follow-up scenario discussions
automation-opportunity-assessment.md	Assess value, feasibility and readiness
opportunity-backlog.md	Track opportunities, owners and next actions

Final Reminder

Return to these six questions whenever you are unsure of the next step:

O1	O2
What is the process?	Where is the pain?
O3	O4
What evidence do we have?	What is the right response?
O5	O6
Is it valuable, feasible and ready?	What is the next best action?

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